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Capability Handoff Guide

Use this guide when you need to describe **what the business can do**, independent of team names, systems, or specific process steps.

This guide is about stable business abilities - the **what**, not the **how**.

KNOWLEDGE AREA

This guide helps with **what the business needs to be able to do**. Technically, it covers **stable business abilities and operating model scope**.

Guide family map

Where this guide sits in the full Blueprint Handoff Atlas family.

ROOT & CROSS-CUTTING

Handoff Atlas | Blueprint Bundle | Metamodel Vocabulary | Migrations

DESIGN

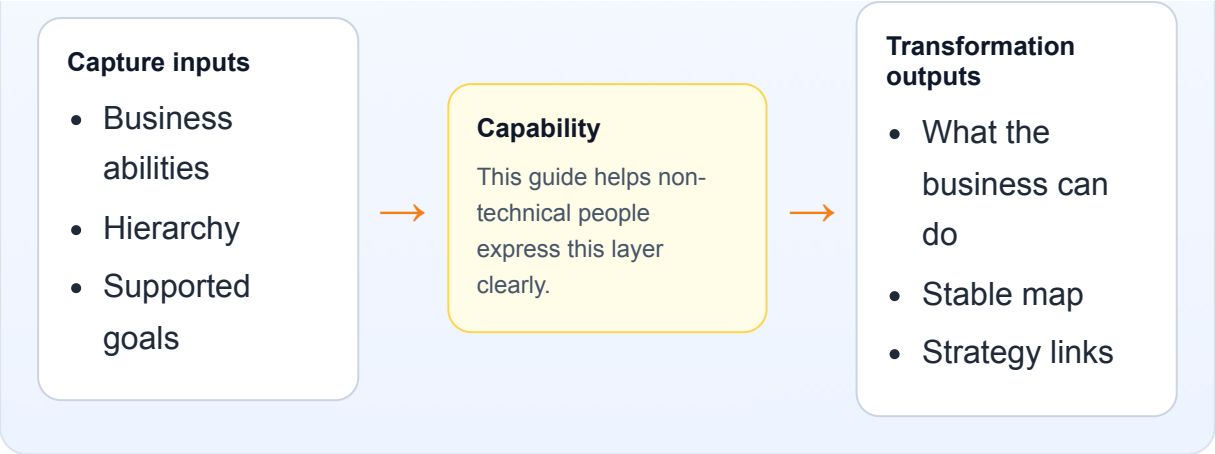
Architecture | Concepts | Domain | Dynamics | Infrastructure | Interactions | Models | Quality | Rules | Story

GOVERNANCE

Capability | Decisions | Motivation | Organization | Roadmap | Leverage | Test Cases | Value Stream

Capture → focus → transformation

What to gather first, what this layer focuses on, and what a modeler or AI agent can produce from it.



Main entities in this guide

- **Capability** - a stable business ability the organization needs, independent of current teams or tools.
  - Often confused with: a process or a **Value Stream**. A capability is what the business must be able to do, not the step-by-step flow or sequence.

What belongs here

- business capabilities
- capability hierarchy or decomposition
- links to important goals, concepts, rules, and operations

What does not belong here

- detailed workflows
- organization charts
- implementation-specific system descriptions

Core things to capture

- the capability name
- what business ability it represents
- how it decomposes into smaller abilities
- what goals it supports
- what concepts, rules, or operations it depends on

Core relationships to capture

- parent capability -> child capability
- capability -> goal supported

- capability -> concept/rule/operation involved

Modus operandi

Start with stable business language:

1. ask what the business must be able to do
2. separate that from teams, tools, and workflows
3. decompose broad capabilities into clearer child capabilities
4. link them to business goals and important domain elements

Prompt set

- what business ability are we describing?
- is this stable over time?
- can it be decomposed into smaller abilities?
- what goals does it support?
- what concepts or rules are central to it?

Free-text intake template

- **Capability name:**
- **Meaning:**
- **Parent capability (if any):**
- **Child capabilities:**
- **Supported goals:**
- **Related concepts/rules/operations:**

Worked example

- Returns Management is a top-level capability
- It decomposes into Request Return, Review Return, and Track Refund Status
- It supports customer self-service and post-purchase operations goals

Layer-specific handoff guidance

For capabilities, the handoff should preserve the **stable business ability** rather than the current implementation.

The receiver should clearly see:

- what the business must be able to do

- how broad capabilities decompose into smaller ones
- what goals or concepts they support

If the description sounds like a workflow or a team backlog item, the capability handoff is too implementation-shaped.

How this becomes YAML

A technical modeler or AI agent can transform this into capability entries and hierarchy links with traceability to goals, concepts, rules, and operations.

Common mistakes

- describing a process instead of a capability
- making capability names tool- or team-specific
- skipping hierarchy when the capability is too broad